



Michigan Tech

Shane Mueller <shanem@mtu.edu>

Re: OpenScales implementations of ACT questionnaires

1 message

Michael Levin <mike.levin@usu.edu>

Wed, Jun 10, 2026 at 11:47 AM

To: Shane Mueller <shanem@mtu.edu>, Michael Twohig <michael.twohig@usu.edu>, Michael Levin <Michael.Levin@usu.edu>

Hi Shane, that sounds like a great project! Here is a written approval for use of the scales I was involved in developing. Some of the others Mike Twohig authored that I wasn't included on so I'll leave those out - AAQ-AHL, AAQ-TTM, AAQ-MCHL, 6-PAQ

I, Michael Levin, assert that I developed and hold the copyright to the following scales (TOF, AAQH, AAQ-US, AAQ-S,) and wish to submit it to OpenScales under CC_BY 4.0 . Contact: mike.levin@usu.edu.

-Mike

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Michael E. Levin, Ph.D. (he/him)

Professor

Utah State University, Department of Psychology

USU ACT Research Group: <https://www.UtahACT.com/>; <https://www.facebook.com/UtahACT>ACT Guide Self-Help Program: <https://ACTGuide.usu.edu>

From: Shane Mueller <shanem@mtu.edu>**Sent:** Tuesday, 09 June 2026 20:04:24**To:** Michael Levin <Michael.Levin@usu.edu>; Michael Twohig <michael.twohig@usu.edu>**Subject:** OpenScales implementations of ACT questionnaires

Hi,

As a brief background, I have recently started the OpenScales project as part of my sabbatical work--an effort to create a format for describing psychological scales and questionnaires, and a repository of freely distributable scales (now approaching 900). You can see the project at <https://openscales.net>, and at the github repository which contains all the scale definitions at <https://github.com/stmueller/OpenScales>. Scales are defined with an open json format called .osd, whose main goal is to incorporate all the logic, scoring, and translations that most scale developers want to express, but are currently only done in pdfs and method sections of papers. Developers of survey software are able to write importing code, and we provide translation software for common platforms. Also, we provide an online javascript runner for self-hosting or demonstration mode, and as part of my PEBL project a desktop-based survey tool that can be used along with other computer-based testing in the lab or online.

I have implemented a number of the ACT scales, but since they have been published in non-open journals, I'm not able to include them in the repository without your permission. I have hosted them privately at the following URLs so that you can see what it would look like (you need the specific URL to access each one, but they are not otherwise linked to the website):

<http://openscales.net/scale.php?code=TOF&repo=private><https://openscales.net/scale.php?code=AAQH&repo=private><https://openscales.net/scale.php?code=AAQ-US&repo=private><https://openscales.net/scale.php?code=AAQ-AHL&repo=private><https://openscales.net/scale.php?code=AAQ-S&repo=private>

<https://openscales.net/scale.php?code=AAQ-TTM&repo=private>
<https://openscales.net/scale.php?code=AAQ-MCHL&repo=private>
<https://openscales.net/scale.php?code=6-PAQ&repo=private>

I'd like to include these scales in the public openscales repository. To do that, we would need you to license these scales via a Creative Commons license or similar open license--most common is the CC_BY 4.0 <https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by/4.0/deed.en> (which requires attribution to the original authors). My interpretation of the legal issues is that when you published these journal articles, they were derivative works of your original questionnaires which you hold the copyright to, and so you can choose to redistribute the scale under CC license on its own without permission of the journal. This could be done by simply attaching CC_BY 4.0 and a url like <https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by/4.0/deed.en> to each of your on-line scale documents. This would allow anyone to access, use, modify, and redistribute your scales without seeking permission from you. Alternately, you can reply with the text below and I will maintain documentation of this and you can simply allow the OpenScales repository to distribute according to your chosen license:

I, [name], assert that I developed and hold the copyright to the following scales (TOF, AAQH, AAQ-US, AAQ-AHL, AAQ-S, AAQ-TTM, AAQ-MCHL, 6-PAQ) and wish to submit it to OpenScales under CC_BY 4.0 . Contact: [email].

Currently, since you already distribute the scales on their own, you are already implicitly granting permissive use, but without explicit license grant, many potential uses are murky. The advantage of doing this is that the scales will be widely available to anyone, directly runnable and scored without worrying about text or coding errors, they will be available and usable after you (and I) retire, users will not need to ask you for permissions to use in research since the usage is laid out in the license, new publications will be free to re-publish the items in tables which makes for better interpretability, and new modified versions can be created and translated more readily. If you choose to do so, you are free to review the scales to ensure they are correct in language and scoring.

Of course, it is your right to restrict use of the scales, or require permission for use, or license them for commercial purposes. In those cases, they might not be appropriate for OpenScales repository, although I do distribute scales that are licensed -NC non-commercial even though it is usually not a good idea. But you would be free to either publicly or privately distribute the .osd files on your own terms--i.e., hosted on your own website, or sent to users directly who request. The .osd files can be downloaded directly from the links, and I'm happy to give you permission to use them for whatever purpose you wish, including hosting them at your website, even if you do not wish to submit them to OpenScales. If you wish to self-host them and not submit them to the repository, I have plans for a registry that will allow us to still include links to your website, and give access to the conversion utilities, but it won't be part of the github repository. I don't want to attach them to the email because I'm afraid it will hit spam filters, but the following link includes all 8 .osd files in a zip archive: <https://drive.google.com/file/d/13wAvjMU8Jd8EGB2RP1hg3wVTXpB72Vca/view?usp=sharing>

Sorry for the very lengthy email, but obviously there are a lot of details to clarify :-). I hope you will consider submitting these to the OpenScales repository, and encourage you to submit future scales as well! I appreciate your time.

Best,
Shane

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Shane Mueller
Professor
Psychology & Human Factors
Michigan Technological University
